

Managing API Keys and Rate Limits

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API keys let your applications authenticate with the CloudDesk API. This article covers creating, rotating, and understanding rate limits for your keys.

Creating a key

Go to Settings → Developer → API Keys → Create Key. Choose whether the key is for production (cd_live_) or sandbox testing (cd_test_). Sandbox data is fully isolated from your production workspace.

Rate limits by plan

Plan	Requests per minute per key
Standard	60
Growth	300
Enterprise	1,200

Exceeding your limit returns a 429 response with a Retry-After header. Implement exponential backoff rather than retrying immediately.

Rotating a key safely

Generate a new key before revoking the old one. Old keys remain valid for 24 hours after a replacement is created, giving you a safe window to update your integration with zero downtime.

Troubleshooting

- **429 errors despite being under your limit:** Contact support — this can indicate a rate-limiter issue on our side, especially if your traffic comes through a shared corporate NAT.
- **resource_not_found for a ticket you can see in the UI:** Double check you're using a live key (cd_live_) and not a sandbox key against production data.
- **OAuth invalid_grant errors:** Authorization codes expire after 60 seconds and can only be used once.

Related: [API Documentation — Authentication](#).